

## 6. Downloading a CSV Dataset

In this section, you will download a CSV dataset.

A **CSV file** is a common type of data file. CSV stands for **comma-separated values**.

A CSV file looks like a spreadsheet, but it is saved as plain text.

### Sample Dataset

For this guide, we will use a small dataset called:

```
mydata.csv
```

It contains information about imaginary students, including:

- Study hours
- Sleep hours
- Attendance
- Quiz score
- Major

If you are viewing this guide as a website, use this link:

[Download the sample CSV dataset](#)



#### Tip

If your browser opens the CSV instead of downloading it, right-click the link and choose **Save Link As...**

### Saving the CSV File

Save the file in your project folder.

Your folder should look like this:

```
r-onboarding-guide/  
  first_script.R  
  first_report.qmd  
  mydata.csv
```

## Verifying the File Exists

In R, you can check whether the file exists:

```
file.exists("mydata.csv")
```

```
[1] TRUE
```

If R prints:

```
[1] TRUE
```

that means R found the file.

If R prints:

```
[1] FALSE
```

that means R did not find the file in the current working directory.

### Common Mistake

The file name must match exactly.  
These are different to R:

```
mydata.csv  
MyData.csv  
mydata (1).csv
```

## If You Do Not Have the File Yet

If your instructor has not provided `mydata.csv`, you can create it yourself.

1. Open a plain text editor.
2. Copy the text below.
3. Save the file as `mydata.csv`.
4. Put it in your project folder.

```
student,study_hours,sleep_hours,attendance,quiz_score,major
Student 1,5,7,Present,78,Biology
Student 2,8,6,Present,91,Business
Student 3,3,8,Absent,65,Psychology
Student 4,6,7,Present,84,Biology
Student 5,7,6,Present,88,Business
Student 6,2,5,Absent,60,Psychology
Student 7,9,8,Present,95,Biology
Student 8,4,6,Present,72,Business
Student 9,6,7,Present,83,Psychology
Student 10,10,7,Present,98,Business
```

#### Tip

Make sure the file name is exactly:

```
mydata.csv
```

not:

```
mydata.csv.txt
```

## Try It Yourself

#### Practice

1. Download or create `mydata.csv`.
2. Save it in your project folder.
3. Run:

```
file.exists("mydata.csv")
```

4. Make sure the result is `TRUE`.

## Check Your Understanding

Answer these questions:

1. What does CSV stand for?

2. Where should you save `mydata.csv`?
3. What does `file.exists("mydata.csv")` check?
4. What does it mean if the result is `FALSE`?

## Summary

In this section, you learned that:

- A CSV file is a common data file.
- CSV files can be opened in spreadsheet programs and R.
- Your CSV file should be saved in your project folder.
- `file.exists()` checks whether R can find the file.